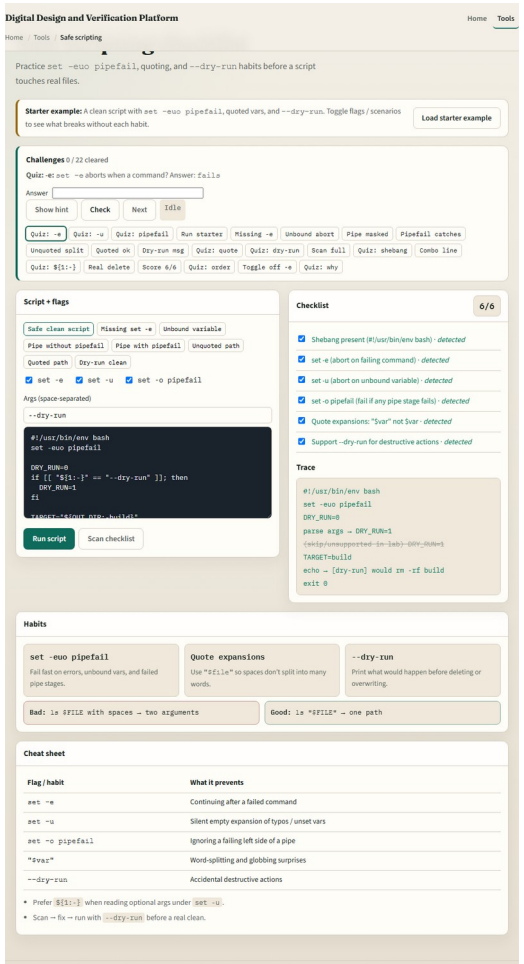
Safe scripting

Scripts that delete files or stop builds can hurt when they run by accident

Fail fast, quote, dry-run

- Set dash-euo pipefail at the top
- Always quote expansions like dollar-file so spaces do not split paths
- For deletes and cleans
- Check that directories exist before you walk them

Browser lab



Safe scripting lab

Real shell practice

wsl – module18-safe-scripting/examples/safe_scripting

```
# Track A – real Unix
# real shell session (Track A)

$ ls tmp/
cache1.tmp
cache2.tmp

$ chmod u+x clean_tmp.sh

$ ./clean_tmp.sh
Would delete: tmp/cache1.tmp (run with --confirm to actually delete)
Would delete: tmp/cache2.tmp (run with --confirm to actually delete)

$ ls tmp/
cache1.tmp
cache2.tmp
```

Real shell — dry-run clean

Real shell practice — try these

```
# ls tmp/ — see the sample cache files before cleaning
ls tmp/

# chmod u+x clean_tmp.sh — make the clean script executable
chmod u+x clean_tmp.sh

# ./clean_tmp.sh — dry run by default (prints Would delete, keeps files)
./clean_tmp.sh

# ls tmp/ — confirm the files are still there
ls tmp/

# ./clean_tmp.sh --confirm — only when ready: actually delete *.tmp
# ./clean_tmp.sh --confirm
```

Pitfalls to watch

- Unquoted variables break on spaces and can make rm touch the wrong paths
- Skipping dry-run on a clean script is how accidents happen
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, finish a few challenges after the starter
- On the real shell, run the dry-run clean and only use confirm when you intend to delete
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to project layout, archives, sed